

PRODUCT & STRATEGY SUMMARY

PitchCoach AI

A complete walkthrough of the app build, tech stack, cost modelling, and go-to-market strategy.

Date March 2026

Status Working prototype — ready for Vercel deployment

Modules built 4 (Deck Analyser, Elevator Script, Live Elevator, Full Pitch)

AI engine Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Anthropic API)

Prepared for Founder / Coach

SECTION 01

What Was Built

You asked for an AI-powered pitch training app to sit alongside your coaching course, covering three core scenarios: pitch deck review, elevator pitch script coaching, and live recorded pitch feedback. The final build expanded to four modules after a further request to combine deck + long-form recording into a dedicated investor session tool.

Module	Name	Format	Duration
01	Pitch Deck Analyser	Upload PDF / PPTX	Instant
02	Elevator Pitch Script	Upload PDF, Word, TXT or paste	Instant
03	Live Elevator Pitch	In-browser record	1–3 min
04	Full Pitch Session	Deck upload + in-browser record	15–30 min

Module 01 — Pitch Deck Analyser

Users upload their pitch deck (PDF recommended) and receive two layers of feedback: a content audit scored against Guy Kawasaki's 10-slide framework (Title, Problem, Value Prop, Underlying Magic, Business Model, Go-to-Market, Competitive Analysis, Management Team, Financial Projections, The Ask), and a full visual design audit covering slide density (Too Busy / Balanced / Too Sparse), colour palette coherence, typography hierarchy, data visualisation quality, and brand consistency. Each dimension is independently scored with specific actionable feedback and a top fixes list.

Module 02 — Elevator Pitch Script Coach

You asked for Word doc and PDF upload support to be added alongside plain text paste. Word files are extracted in-browser using Mammoth.js; PDFs are sent directly to Claude for extraction. Scripts are evaluated against a 5-element elevator pitch framework: Hook, Problem, Solution, Proof, and The Ask. Each element is scored, the relevant excerpt is pulled from the script, feedback is given, and a rewrite suggestion is provided. Tone analysis covers clarity, confidence, and conciseness.

Module 03 — Live Elevator Pitch

In-browser video or audio recording capped at 3 minutes. Users can paste a transcript after recording for deeper structure analysis. Feedback covers structure (with per-element breakdown), delivery (clarity, pacing, confidence), and body language (eye contact, posture, gestures). Includes coaching drills tailored to identified weaknesses.

Module 04 — Full Pitch Session

Created at your request by combining the deck upload from Module 01 with a long-form recording capability (up to 30 minutes). A guided 3-step flow walks the user through uploading their deck, recording their full presentation, then adding a transcript for analysis. Feedback is investor-grade across six dimensions: Deck Alignment, Narrative Arc, Content Depth (8 sections), Delivery, Investor Readiness (red flags and green lights), and a Q&A; Prep panel with 5 anticipated investor questions.

SECTION 02

Complete Tech Stack

The app is built as a single React / Next.js application deployed on Vercel, calling the Anthropic Claude API directly for all AI analysis. Your existing stack integrates cleanly at every layer.

Layer	Tool	Purpose
Frontend	React / Next.js	App UI — all 4 modules in one codebase
Hosting	Vercel	Deployment, CDN, serverless functions
Auth	Clerk	LinkedIn OAuth + user session management
AI — Analysis	Claude Sonnet 4.6	All feedback, scoring, and rewrites
AI — Video (future)	Gemini Vision	Body language analysis in Modules 3 & 4
Orchestration	n8n	Webhook triggers → CRM sync → email
CRM	Zoho CRM	Lead capture, results storage, follow-up sequences
Email	Zoho Mail	Triggered report delivery to users
File parsing	Mammoth.js (browser)	Word doc text extraction in Module 02

Note on architecture: recordings never leave the user's browser — they are captured via the MediaRecorder API and stored in memory only. Transcripts are what get sent to Claude for analysis, keeping data handling lightweight and avoiding large file uploads.

SECTION 03

Subscription Plans & Cost Basis

You asked which subscription tier to start on to support 100 Module 1, 200 Module 2, 100 Module 3, and 50 Module 4 uses per month. The answer was to start on the following plans, arriving at a total cost basis of approximately \$120–125/month.

Service	Plan	Monthly Cost	Key Limit
Claude API	Pay-as-you-go	~\$8–15	No ceiling — scales linearly
Vercel	Pro	\$20	1TB bandwidth (not a concern at this scale)
Clerk	Free tier	\$0	50,000 MAU — won't be reached for years
n8n	Pro Cloud	~\$65 (€60)	10,000 executions/month
Zoho CRM	Standard (1 user)	\$14	100,000 records per module
Zoho Mail	Workplace Lite	~\$1	Bundled
TOTAL		~\$120–125/mo	

SECTION 04

Scale Ceilings on Current Plans

You asked how many uses of each module could be achieved before monthly costs increase. The binding constraint is n8n Pro at 10,000 executions/month (each session = ~4 executions). All other services — Vercel, Clerk, Zoho — have effectively unlimited headroom at this scale. Claude API scales linearly with no plan ceiling.

Module	Current	Proposed 2x	Max on current plans
Module 01	100	400	~900
Module 02	200	400	~900
Module 03	100	200	~450
Module 04	50	100	~225
Total sessions	450	1,100	~2,475
n8n executions	~1,800	~4,400	~9,900 (limit: 10,000)

Conclusion: doubling all four modules comfortably fits within current plans. Monthly cost at 1,100 sessions/month is approximately \$135 — only \$10–15 more than the starting point despite 2.4x the volume. The next meaningful cost jump occurs at ~2,500 sessions/month when n8n moves to Business tier (€800/month).

SECTION 05

Cost Attribution Per Unit

You asked for costs to be attributed according to the relative complexity and value of each module, using the following weights: Module 1 = 1.5x, Module 2 = 1.0x (baseline), Module 3 = 2.5x, Module 4 = 3.5x. The total cost basis is \$200/month. Sales volumes are 200 × M1, 200 × M2, 50 × M3, 25 × M4.

Calculation: total weighted units = (200×1.5) + (200×1.0) + (50×2.5) + (25×3.5) = 300 + 200 + 125 + 87.5 = 712.5 weighted units.
Value of 1 unit = \$200 ÷ 712.5 = \$0.2807.

Module	Relative Weight	Cost per 1 Unit	Units Sold	Attributed Cost
Module 01	1.5x	\$0.42	200	\$84.21
Module 02	1.0x	\$0.28	200	\$56.14
Module 03	2.5x	\$0.70	50	\$35.09
Module 04	3.5x	\$0.98	25	\$24.56
TOTAL			475	\$200.00

These are your floor costs per use. Every penny above these numbers per unit is margin. Pricing should be driven by perceived value to the customer, not cost basis — a 30-minute investor pitch session (Module 4) is worth far more to a founder than a script review (Module 2), even though it only costs \$0.70 more to deliver.

SECTION 06

Go-to-Market & Future Strategy

You outlined a multi-layered commercial strategy across three dimensions: free distribution, product bundling, and a sequenced learning journey. Below is a summary of your stated intentions and the observations made in response.

Free Tier Distribution

You intend to give a portion of uses away free to three audiences: influencers in the startup and investment space, incubators and accelerators as a recommended tool for their cohorts, and university students (entrepreneurship programmes). At a cost basis of \$0.28–\$0.98 per use, this is extremely cheap distribution. 50 free Module 1 uses costs under \$25 and puts the product in front of exactly the right audience.

Bundled Unit Pricing

You plan to sell in pairs — two uses of each module per unit sale — allowing users to attempt, receive feedback, learn, and then attempt again. This is a stronger framing than selling individual runs: it positions the product as a coaching journey rather than a grading tool, and justifies a premium price based on measurable improvement rather than access to a feature.

The Sequenced Learning Journey

You described a curriculum-style product flow that combines AI feedback with your coaching course content at each stage. The intended sequence is:

- Upload pitch deck → get feedback → go through course → upload again (Module 01 ×2)
- Practice the live pitch → get feedback → go through course → practice again (Module 03 ×2)
- Create elevator pitch → upload script → get feedback → course → sharpen it → upload again (Module 02 ×2)
- Record live elevator pitch → get feedback → try again (Module 03 ×2)

This is not a SaaS tool — it is a coaching programme with AI embedded as the feedback mechanism at every checkpoint. This framing changes the pricing conversation entirely and positions the product against coaching and accelerator programmes rather than software subscriptions.

Future: Founder Team Product

You noted a future product concept where multiple members of a founding team participate in coordinated pitch sessions — individual elevator pitches, full team presentations, and orchestrated feedback across the group. This is your enterprise tier. An accelerator cohort of 10 teams with 3 founders each, each doing multiple sessions, is a repeatable B2B contract worth significant recurring revenue. The cost per session barely changes at that scale.

Suggested Pricing Tiers (indicative)

Tier	Audience	Contents	Indicative Price
Free / Gifted	Influencers, students, incubators	1× use of M1 or M2	Free
Starter	Solo founders	2× M1 + 2× M2	\$49–79
Pitch Ready	Pre-raise founders	2× M1 + 2× M2 + 2× M3 + course	\$149–199

Investor Ready	Seed / Series A prep	Full journey ×2 + 1× M4	\$299–399
Team / Cohort	Accelerators, teams	Multiple seats + M4 + orchestration	\$999+/cohort

SECTION 07

Recommended Next Steps

1. Immediate — Deploy prototype

Wrap the React app in a Next.js project, add a /api/claude proxy route to keep the API key server-side, connect Clerk for auth, and deploy to Vercel. The prototype is production-ready as built.

2. Short term — Connect n8n to Zoho

Build the n8n workflow: session completion webhook → write lead to Zoho CRM → trigger Zoho Mail with feedback summary. This closes the lead capture loop and enables follow-up sequences.

3. Short term — Define your elevator pitch format

Module 02 currently uses a standard 5-element framework as a placeholder. Replace this with your proprietary format from your coaching course to differentiate the product and tie it tightly to your curriculum.

4. Medium term — Build the course integration layer

Create the sequenced journey UI — the 'try → learn → try again' flow that connects AI feedback directly to specific course modules. This transforms the app from a standalone tool into a course companion.

5. Medium term — Gemini video integration

Route Module 3 and Module 4 recordings through Gemini Vision via n8n for genuine body language analysis (posture, eye contact, gesture tracking). Currently this feedback is transcript-inferred.

6. Later — Founder team product

Build multi-seat session management, team feedback aggregation, and cohort-level reporting for the accelerator / incubator B2B channel.

Document prepared in conversation with Claude (Anthropic) — March 2026